

DEEP RESEARCH / DUBBO NSW 2830

\$100 PC Challenge

How powerful a complete usable computer can we actually buy for AUD \$100 all-in?

TODAY'S PRACTICAL ANSWER

\$99

HP ProDesk 600 G1 SFF

Intel Core i5-4590 · 8GB RAM · 128GB SSD

Research date: 2026-09-23

Hard rule: item + shipping + mandatory fees + required parts $\leq$ AUD \$100

Prices can change quickly. Auction observations are not final purchase prices.

\$100

EXECUTIVE ANSWER

What \$100 can genuinely buy in this snapshot

The strongest fixed-price desktop evidence in the canonical dataset includes HP ProDesk 600 G1 SFF at \$99 (Intel Core i5-4590, 8GB RAM, 128GB SSD) and Dell OptiPlex 9020 SFF at \$99 (Intel Core i7-4770, 8GB RAM, 500GB HDD).

The first is the stronger ready-to-use proposition because its SSD matters immediately; the second has the stronger CPU but a mechanical HDD. Dell OptiPlex 7050 Micro remains a watch item because its \$73.61 total was only an observed running auction total, not a final purchase price.

No complete dedicated-GPU gaming PC at or below the hard budget was verified in the underlying research sweep. The practical lesson remains: at this price, complete ex-office systems are much easier to verify than multi-part gaming builds.

CATEGORY	WINNER / FIND	OBSERVED COST
Best ready-to-use	HP ProDesk 600 G1 SFF Intel Core i5-4590 / 8GB / 128GB SSD	\$99; free delivery advertised
Best CPU	Dell OptiPlex 9020 SFF Intel Core i7-4770 / 8GB / 500GB HDD	\$99; free delivery advertised
Best auction watch	Dell OptiPlex 7050 Micro Intel Core i5-7500T / 4GB / 128GB SSD	\$73.61 observed; not final
Cheapest useful box	HP T630 Thin Client AMD GX-420GI / 8GB / 32GB SSD	\$68; \$10 delivery advertised

Shipping confidence matters: an advertised delivery price is not the same as a destination-specific checkout verification to postcode 2830. The canonical data records that distinction.

Canonical listing cards

Best ready-to-use

HP ProDesk 600 G1 SFF

\$99

free delivery advertised

CPU	Intel Core i5-4590
GPU	Intel HD Graphics 4600
RAM	8GB
Storage	128GB SSD

The SSD makes this the strongest no-fuss complete desktop in the research snapshot.

Direct eBay item URL is retained for provenance, but it could not be independently confirmed as a current \$99 active listing on 23 September 2026. Current public eBay results for comparable HP ProDesk 600 G1 systems are substantially higher, so this record has been removed from actionable deals pending re-verification. Risks: Weak integrated graphics; Small 128GB SSD; SFF limits GPU upgrades

[Open source listing / search](#)

Best CPU

Dell OptiPlex 9020 SFF

\$99

free delivery advertised

CPU	Intel Core i7-4770
GPU	Intel HD Graphics 4600
RAM	8GB
Storage	500GB HDD

Strongest raw CPU found at the hard cap, but the mechanical HDD is a responsiveness compromise.

Search-result fallback rather than a stable direct listing URL. Free delivery was shown in the surfaced result; postcode-2830 checkout was not verified. Risks: Search URL may surface a different item later; HDD rather than SSD; Weak integrated graphics

[Open source listing / search](#)

Cheapest useful box

HP T630 Thin Client

\$68

\$10 delivery advertised

CPU	AMD GX-420GI
GPU	Integrated Radeon
RAM	8GB
Storage	32GB SSD

Useful as a tiny Linux/basic desktop or service box, not a gaming machine.

Direct eBay item page independently re-opened on 23 September 2026. It showed AU \$58, more than 10 available, 16 sold, and AU \$10 delivery. The page's displayed delivery destination was not postcode 2830, so shipping remains 'advertised' rather than postcode-verified. Risks: Only 32GB storage; No operating system; Low-end embedded CPU

[Open source listing / search](#)

Auction watch

Dell OptiPlex 7050 Micro

**\$73.61
observed***

\$20.25 delivery advertised

CPU	Intel Core i5-7500T
GPU	Intel HD Graphics 630
RAM	4GB
Storage	128GB SSD

Interesting newer platform if it closes below the budget, but it is not a confirmed sub-\$100 purchase.

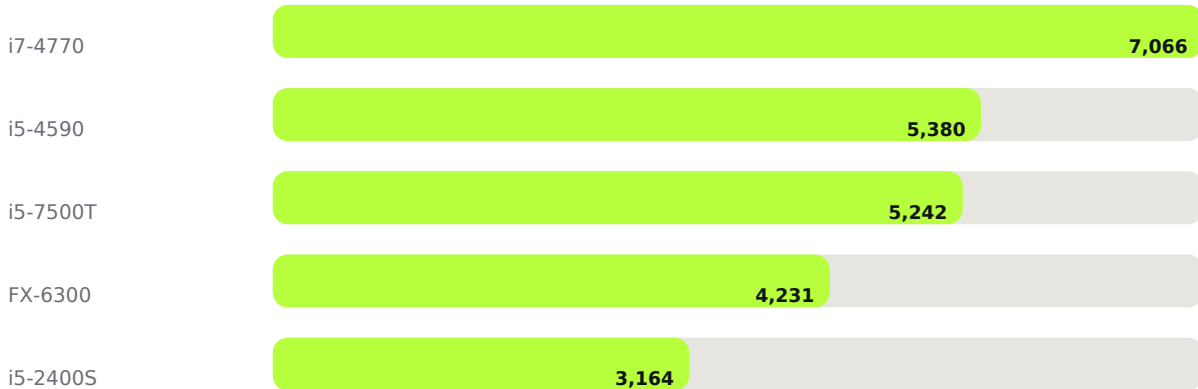
Observed auction bid plus advertised postage only. The final auction price was not known, and the source URL is a search fallback. Risks: Auction price can rise; Search URL may surface a different item later; Only 4GB RAM

[Open source listing / search](#)

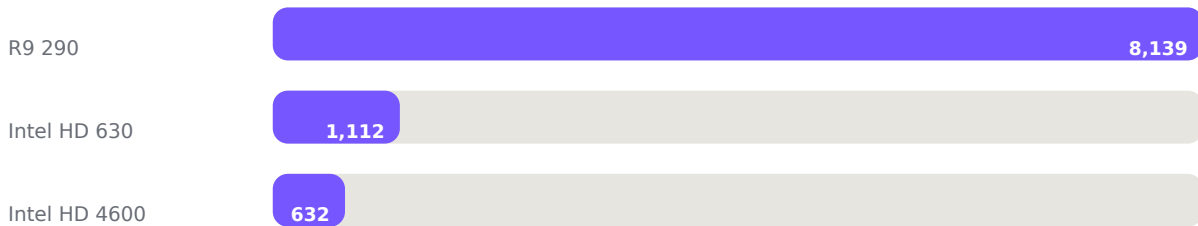
\$100 buys CPU, RAM and storage more reliably than gaming GPU power

The benchmark snapshot below is contextual evidence, not a direct FPS prediction.

CPU Mark



3D Graphics Mark



The existing R9 290 remains in a completely different graphics tier from the integrated GPUs in the sub-\$100 office systems. These bargains are primarily general-purpose, retro and light-game machines.

What other source types add

SOURCE	ROLE
eBay Australia	Strongest structured public leads in this snapshot; production API automation remains approval-gated.
Gumtree	Useful classifieds evidence, but treated as manual research rather than an unattended scrape target.
Facebook Marketplace	Strategically important local blind spot; use manual/user-assisted imports rather than unauthorised scraping.
Cash Converters	Potential fixed-price used inventory; automation requires a source-access review.
OzBargain	Useful historical price evidence; bargain posts can expire quickly.
Mainstream retailers	More useful for parts/clearance than complete systems at the \$100 cap.
Dubbo local	Offline stock, disposals and user-submitted local listings may beat web-indexed deals.

Why a parts build usually loses at \$100

A useful used GPU can consume half the budget. Barebones need RAM/storage/power; separate postage destroys combinations; and SFF machines often impose profile, power and physical-fit constraints. A complete ex-office system benefits from one acquisition and one evidence trail.

Source-policy implication

CHEAP//PC should optimise for the best defensible bargain, not the lowest number scraped from the web. Direct listing evidence, freshness and shipping confidence belong beside price.

[CHEAP//PC source strategy](#)

FINAL VERDICT

How powerful can \$100 genuinely be?

Current evidence-based answer

**Intel Core i5-4590 or Intel Core i7-4770 class
desktop + 8GB RAM + SSD/HDD + integrated
graphics + complete ex-office chassis**

That remains a capable older general-purpose computer rather than a modern gaming rig. The exact winner can change quickly, which is why this report now obtains listing facts from the same canonical JSON used by the website and CI validator.

The next quality leap is automated, authorised refresh plus price/history snapshots—not adding more hard-coded prices to generated reports.

Canonical shortlist source links

[HP ProDesk 600 G1 SFF](#)

[Dell OptiPlex 9020 SFF](#)

[HP T630 Thin Client](#)

[Dell OptiPlex 7050 Micro](#)

Snapshot warning: used-listing prices, stock, bids and delivery eligibility can change at any time. Re-open listings before buying. Auction bid values are observations, not guaranteed purchase prices.